

Daily Need to Know

Friday, 21 August 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1

Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED CLOSE, 16:00 ET / 04:00 GMT+8			
S&P 500	7,641.16	▼ -0.87%	Range 7,639–7,700 ; closed 2.15 points off the low, at 3.5% of the day's range. Below the Hedgeye risk-range floor of 7,652. 2.25% under the 52-week high.
Nasdaq Composite	26,067.17	▼ -1.00%	Closed at 18.3% of range — the least ugly of the four, and still below its 26,103 band floor.
Dow Jones Industrial	52,759.21	▼ -1.32%	– 703.84 points , closing 4.31 points off the low — 0.7% of range. Walmart alone (–9.0%) accounted for roughly a third of the fall.
Russell 2000	2,992.43	▼ -1.34%	Worst of the four majors. At 2.6% of its 2,990–3,085 band — 2.43 points above the floor. Made a record as recently as 14 August.
Philadelphia SOX	11,800.01	▲ +0.53%	The only major index up. Closed at 70.3% of range on memory strength. Still 19.5% below its 52-week high.
INDEX FUTURES — GLOBEX, CAPTURED 06:07 GMT+8, 10-MINUTE DELAYED FEED			
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,662.50	▼ -0.86%	Settled 7,662.50 against a 7,657.75–7,746.50 Globex range. Volume 1.40m vs 1.12m 10-day average — a 25% heavy tape.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,300.50	▼ -0.72%	Held up better than ES. Volume 550k on a 475k average. Nvidia earnings on Wednesday is the gating event.
E-mini Dow (YM)	52,849	▼ -1.27%	Low 52,812 — the futures never traded meaningfully below the cash low. No overnight capitulation.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,999.20	▼ -1.34%	Volume 154k on a 124k average: the small-cap unwind is where the volume went.
US TREASURY YIELDS — LIVE, 06:07 GMT+8			
US 10-year	4.708%	▲ +6.7 bp	Round-tripped Wednesday's buyback rally and more. High 4.714% — within a basis point of the 52-week high of 4.748%. At 75% of Hedgeye's 4.61–4.74% band.
US 30-year	5.250%	▲ +6.1 bp	Back to 5.25% after Wednesday took it from a 19-year high of 5.34% down to 5.19%. The intervention bought one day.
US 5-year	4.394%	▲ +5.5 bp	The belly moved with the long end, not the front — consistent with a term-premium repricing rather than a policy repricing.
US 13-week bill	3.797%	▲ +0.5 bp	Essentially anchored. 10s–3m at +91.1 bp ; the front end is not participating in any of this.
ENERGY — LIVE, 06:07 GMT+8			
WTI crude (CL1!)	\$86.83	▲ +2.89%	Highest in nearly a month. Range 84.23–87.69. At 76% of the 80.95–88.70 band, which itself moved up 1.4 points overnight.
Brent crude (BZ1!)	\$93.78	▲ +2.36%	Touched 94.72 intraday. The Brent–WTI spread at \$6.95 is the Hormuz risk premium, and it is widening.
Henry Hub gas (NG1!)	\$2.733	▼ -2.88%	Fell while crude surged — the only clean evidence this is a geopolitical supply story, not a demand story.
RBOB gasoline	\$3.0091	▲ +1.06%	Lagged crude badly (+1.06% vs +2.89%). Crack compression is the refiners' problem if this holds.
METALS — SPOT LEVEL LIVE AT 06:07 GMT+8; DAY CHANGE MEASURED ON THE COMEX CONTRACT			
Gold (spot)	\$4,520.35	▲ +0.57%	Spot sits at 88% of a 4,304–4,550 band whose ceiling Hedgeye lifted 104 points overnight. Futures settled 4,571.40.
Silver (spot)	\$68.156	▲ +3.46%	The day's standout metal. Hedgeye moved silver from neutral to bullish TREND and raised the band to 63–69; spot is at 86% of it.
Copper (spot)	\$6.4407	▼ -0.42%	The dissenter. At just 25% of its 6.35–6.71 band — copper is not confirming the reflation trade gold and silver are pricing.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
CURRENCIES & VOLATILITY — LIVE, 06:07 GMT+8			
Dollar index (DXY)	98.839	◆ see note	Down more than 1% in two days and ~2.5% quarter-to-date. Hedgeye cut the band floor 74 bp to 98.37–99.96; DXY sits at 29% of it, bearish TREND.
USD/JPY	159.023	◆ see note	Yen is one of Hedgeye's three currency longs and all three are flagged immediate-term overbought. Nikkei closed +1.36% Thursday.
USD/KRW	1,394.05	◆ see note	Won weaker even as KOSPI ripped +5.89% — foreign money chasing the chip tape without hedging the currency.
VIX	16.02	▲ +7.66%	Closed at 90% of its own daily range and 92% of Hedgeye's 13.99–16.19 band. Still absolutely low — 16 handles are not fear.
Bitcoin	\$72,570	▲ +4.74%	The one asset that kept the Treasury's gift. Range 68,866–72,950; highest since early June. Still 42% below its 52-week high of 126,230.

▲ higher ▼ lower ◆ flat, or change basis not comparable — see footnote. Green = up, red = down, amber = flat or unresolved.

Cash equity rows are settled closes. Futures, yields, metals, FX and crypto are live levels at the 06:07 GMT+8 capture. Spot metals and FX roll their trading session at 17:00–18:00 ET, seven minutes before capture, so the percentage change those series report is a few minutes old and is **not** Thursday's move; for gold, silver and copper the change column therefore uses the COMEX contract, and for DXY, USD/JPY and USD/KRW no comparable day change was available from a single source this morning. Levels are correct in every case. Full reconciliation in section 18.

TL;DR

The US Treasury tried to hold the long end down and lost the argument in a single session. Wednesday's expanded buyback took the 30-year from a 19-year high of 5.34% to 5.19%; by Thursday's close it was back at **5.25%** and the 10-year at **4.708%**, up 6.7 bp, within a basis point of its 52-week high. Every basis point of relief was returned.

Equities paid for it. The Dow fell **703.84 points** and closed **4.31 points** off its low; the S&P closed **2.15 points** off its low. Closing on the low after a failed policy rally is a distribution pattern, not a dip.

Bitcoin kept the gift — **+4.7% to \$72,570**, its best level since June. The intervention repriced crypto and oil, and did not reprice the bond market it was aimed at. That is the whole story of the session.

Two of Hedgeye's three headline equity ranges — **SPX and the Nasdaq Composite** — closed **below their floors**, the Russell sits 2.4 points above its own, and VIX finished at **92%** of its band. Four instruments at the bearish extreme of ranges the model still labels bullish TREND.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. The Treasury discovered the limit of its own balance sheet in twenty-four hours. On Wednesday the Treasury said it would more than double repurchases of 10-, 20- and 30-year debt — from \$2bn to at least \$4bn per long-end operation, and from two operations a quarter to four, effective 9 September. The 30-year fell about 15 bp from Tuesday's 19-year peak of 5.34%. By Thursday's close the 10-year was **+6.7 bp at 4.708%** and the 30-year **+6.1 bp at 5.25%**. A buyback is a change in the composition of supply, not in its quantity; the market tested that distinction and won.

2. The move was in term premium, not in policy expectations. The 2-year rose just **2.8 bp** to 4.190% while the 5-year rose 5.5 bp and the 30-year 6.1 bp. The 10s–2s curve steepened to **+51.8 bp** and 30s–10s to **+54.2 bp**. Nothing about Thursday said the Fed will be tighter. Everything about it said investors want to be paid more to own duration — which is precisely the variable a buyback cannot legislate.

3. Walmart turned a rates story into a consumer story. Walmart beat on both lines — \$0.81 against \$0.74, revenue \$187.9bn against \$186.75bn — and raised full-year guidance. The stock fell **9%** anyway, because US comparable sales grew just **2.6%** against a 3.8% consensus, the slowest since 2020, and average ticket grew 1.1% against 3.1% a year ago. The third-quarter EPS guide of \$0.62–0.64 missed a \$0.68 consensus. When the company that wins the trade-down trade reports decelerating traffic value, the read is about the customer, not the retailer.

4. The closes are worse than the headline percentages. The Dow closed **4.31 points** off a 626-point range low; the S&P **2.15 points** off a 61-point range low; the Russell at **7.3%** of its range. Three of four majors finished in the bottom tenth of the day. That is a market with no bid into the bell, and it happened on ES volume of **1.40m** against a 1.12m ten-day average — heavy, not holiday-thin.

5. Semiconductors went the other way, and that is the genuine dissent. The SOX rose **0.53%** while every other major index fell, on Micron **+3.97%**, SanDisk **+2.02%** and Western Digital **+1.51%** — memory, not logic. Nvidia fell 0.33%. The rotation inside semis is away from the AI-accelerator complex and into the shortage trade, and the SOX is still **19.5%** below its 52-week high while the S&P is 2.25% below its own. The index that led the cycle has not participated in the last leg of it.

6. Two interventions, one worked. The same Treasury announcement that failed to hold yields down took Bitcoin up **4.7% to \$72,570**, its best since early June, after an 8.2% surge and roughly \$3bn of short liquidations on Wednesday. Crude rose **2.89%** on Trump's threat of a "crushing economic operation" against Iran. Policy is moving the assets it did not target and failing to move the one it did — the definition of a transmission problem.

7. The calendar now does the work. Nvidia reports Wednesday after the close, and Fed Chair Kevin Warsh gives his first Jackson Hole keynote on Friday 28 August. Hedgeye's framing is the right one: the question is not whether the Treasury wants lower long yields, but whether the Fed will help. Until Warsh speaks, the buyback is an unfunded promise, and Thursday was the market saying so.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The whole curve steepened from the back.** 2-year **4.190%** (+2.8 bp), 5-year **4.394%** (+5.5 bp), 10-year **4.708%** (+6.7 bp), 30-year **5.250%** (+6.1 bp). 10s–2s at **+51.8 bp**, against the +25 bp of late June that Hedgeye flagged this week. Six months of steepening has happened without a single Fed move.
- **Bond volatility rose but stayed contained.** The MOVE index closed **73.18**, up 2.69%, still comfortably below the 75 threshold and far below its 115 twelve-month high. The long end sold off in an orderly fashion — which is worse for the intervention thesis than a disorderly one, because it means nobody was forced.
- **Credit did not flinch.** HYG fell just **0.19%** to 79.56, sitting mid-band and bullish TREND; LQD fell 0.48% to 106.06, which is a duration effect rather than a spread effect. Equity fell 0.87% and high yield fell a fifth of that. Credit is not corroborating the equity tape.
- **The dollar is the pivot everything else hangs on.** DXY at **98.84** is down more than 1% in two sessions and ~2.5% quarter-to-date. Hedgeye cut the band floor by **74 bp** in a single publication — the largest overnight band shift in the set — and holds short USD alongside long gold, long euro and long yen, with all three longs flagged overbought.
- **Gold and silver are pricing the reflation; copper is not.** Gold spot **\$4,520** sits at 88% of its band, silver spot **\$68.16** at 86% and newly upgraded to bullish TREND, but copper spot **\$6.4407** sits at just **25%** of its own. Copper is the industrial vote and it is abstaining. Silver futures rose 3.46% on the day against gold futures' 0.57% — the gold–silver ratio compressed hard, which is a monetary-debasement signature rather than an industrial one.
- **Crude carries a war premium that gas does not share.** WTI **+2.89% to \$86.83** and Brent **+2.36% to \$93.78**, both roughly month-highs, while Henry Hub fell **2.88% to \$2.733**. Energy demand did not change on Thursday; the probability of a Hormuz supply interruption did. Hedgeye's macro team flipped bullish Energy this week and simultaneously cautioned against chasing crude at these levels.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

DASHBOARD	READING	WHAT IT IMPLIES
Monthly Quad	Quad 3 now, model forecasting Quad 1 next month	Quad path 3 → 1 → 2, unchanged from the prior edition. The team stressed on Thursday's Macro Show that Quad 1 is a <i>forecast</i> , not a completed transition, and that the Signals — not the forecast — are the timing mechanism.
Inflation Nowcast	Headline CPI +3.48% y/y for August	Up 1 bp from the 13 August estimate and +12 bp sequential acceleration against the slowing the government reported for July. Reported 11 September. Model has 3Q26 at 3.43% and 4Q26 at 3.61%, with no meaningful disinflation until 2Q27 at 1.72%.
Largest currency book	Short USD; long gold, euro, yen	All three longs signalling immediate-term TRADE overbought inside bullish TRENDS. Gold carries a USD trending inverse correlation of −0.93 ; Bitcoin picked up a USD TRADE inverse correlation of −0.88 on Wednesday's breakout.
Sector positioning	Long Healthcare, bullish Energy (new), short High Beta Momentum, short Utilities (reduced)	The clearest strategic change this week is Energy flipping bullish on resource constraints, falling inventories, tight diesel and geopolitical disruption. XLV was trimmed, not exited , into Wednesday's +3.5% day; part of the XLU short was covered.
Curve	10s–2s +51.8 bp at capture	Against the "+50bps this morning" cited in Thursday's Early Look and +25 bp in late June. 2-year remains below immediate-term TRADE support; 10-year remains bullish TRADE and TREND.
ETF Pro change	Removed short: MSTY (11.52–13.26)	Published 21:50 GMT+8 Thursday. A short covered because the position broke TRADE and/or TREND — consistent with the Bitcoin breakout running through the MicroStrategy complex.

Sources: Early Look, 20 Aug 20:22 GMT+8; The Macro Show summary, 20 Aug 22:12 GMT+8; ETF Pro Plus update, 20 Aug 21:50 GMT+8.

Risk Range™ Signals — the live set is Thursday 20 August's Early Look, *Double MAX Macro!*, by Keith McCullough, published **20:22 GMT+8**. Tonight's Early Look supersedes it at roughly 19:30–20:30 GMT+8. Position is measured against the live print at 06:07 GMT+8, on the series Hedgeye names.

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS, AND HOW THE BAND MOVED
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,652–7,815	bullish below floor	Closed 7,641.16 — 10.84 points below the floor . Band ceiling raised 4 points; floor unchanged. A bullish-TREND instrument closing under its own floor is the single most important line in this table.
Nasdaq Composite	26,103–26,851	bullish below floor	Closed 26,067.17 , 35.83 below the floor . Ceiling cut 48 points and floor cut 1 — the band narrowed from above as the index fell out of the bottom.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,990–3,085	bullish 2.6%	Closed 2,992.43 , just 2.43 points above the floor. Ceiling up 2. Small caps have the least room left of anything in the set.
UST 10-year yield	4.61–4.74%	bullish 75.4%	At 4.708% , up from mid-band a day ago. Floor cut 2 bp to 4.61%; ceiling held at 4.74%. Yields pressing the top of a range the model already calls bullish.
High Yield (HYG)	79.35–79.86	bullish 41.2%	At 79.56 , mid-band and unbothered. Band shifted up on both ends (+0.17 / +0.08) even as equities fell — credit is the calmest series here.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	105.40–106.90	bearish 44.0%	At 106.06 . Band up 0.10 / 0.30. The only fixed-income line Hedgeye marks bearish TREND, and it is behaving.
Health Care (XLV)	167–177	bullish 53.9%	At 172.39 after giving back 1.87%. Ceiling raised 5 points and floor 1 — the band widened to absorb Wednesday's squeeze. Core long, trimmed not exited.
Equal Weight (RSP)	219.00–225.00	bullish 21.3%	At 220.28 , in the bottom quarter. Band up 1 point both ends. The average stock is closer to its floor than the cap-weighted index is.
VIX	13.99–16.19	bearish 92.3%	At 16.02 after +7.66%. Ceiling cut 0.44 to 16.19, so the band came down as VIX went up — the position deteriorated from both directions.
US Dollar (DXY)	98.37–99.96	bearish 29.5%	At 98.839 . Floor cut 74 bp , ceiling 13 bp: the largest band move in the set, and it happened downward while Hedgeye is short. The signal chased the price.
WTI crude (continuous)	80.95–88.70	bullish 75.9%	At 86.83 . Band lifted 1.44 / 1.24. Upper quartile, bullish TREND, and the macro team turned outright bullish Energy this week.
Natural gas (continuous)	2.55–2.89	bearish 53.8%	At 2.733 , mid-band. Floor cut 4 cents, ceiling unchanged. Diverged from crude by 5.8 percentage points on the day.
Gold spot	4,304–4,550	bullish 87.9%	At \$4,520.35 . Ceiling raised 104 points and floor 8 — the biggest upward band revision in the table, tracking the dollar break.
Copper spot	6.35–6.71	bullish 25.2%	At \$6.4407 . Band effectively unchanged (–0.03 / +0.01). The lone commodity in the bottom third and the clearest internal contradiction in the set.
Silver spot	63–69	bullish 85.9%	At \$68.156 . TREND signal upgraded neutral → bullish and the band raised 1 / 3. The only signal change in the set overnight.

Position measured on the series Hedgeye names: spot for gold, silver and copper (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD); the continuous contract for crude and natural gas (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!). Band moves are Thursday 20 August's published levels against Wednesday 19 August's. IGV (99–106, bullish, ceiling cut 1) is published in the set but omitted above for space; it is not at an extreme.

What Keith actually said — verbatim, from *Double MAX Macro!*, Early Look, 20 August 2026, 20:22 GMT+8 (08:22 ET), unless noted.

- “While I don’t see the humility in manipulating markets for political gain, I am quite interested in observing how the latest attempt to bend and smooth God’s gravity works out.”
- “UST 10yr Yield remains Bullish TRADE and TREND with a Risk Range™ Signal = 4.63–4.74%” — note that the published levels table in the same note carries **4.61–4.74**; the prose retains the prior day's floor.
- “For those of you who talk to Bessy regularly, remind him that he doesn’t just need a Down Dollar to signal US economic (and stock market) acceleration, he needs a steepening Yield Curve.”
- “Our August Nowcast is for headline CPI of +3.48% y/y, +1 bp higher than our last published estimate on 08/13, and marks +12 bps of sequential acceleration.”

- “In other news, consensus Hedge Funds had one of their worst days of August yesterday. Expect their ‘bearish’ views to reflect their performance.”
- “All 3 of those positions are signaling immediate-term TRADE #Overbought within their Bullish TRENDS.” — on being long gold, euros and yen simultaneously.
- From *KM's Top 3 Things (USD/Asia/Factors)*, 19 August 2026, 19:31 GMT+8: “in 27 years of playing The Game, it’s rare that I am long of both Euros (FXE) and Yens (FXY) at the same time”.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVDA	216.85	▼ -0.33%	\$5.25T	Least bad of the seven, and the one that matters: reports Wednesday after the close . Hedgeye expects a beat and better guidance to be consensus; the variable is order growth.
AAPL	311.30	▼ -1.75%	\$4.54T	Worst Mag7 loss bar Amazon. Traded 310.65–320.28 — a 3.1% range on 40.9m shares. Recovered 0.24% after hours.
MSFT	481.15	▼ -0.65%	\$3.57T	Held up: half the S&P's decline. The defensive end of mega-cap tech is doing its job.
GOOGL	340.67	▼ -1.17%	\$4.15T	Gave back 1.17% with no company-specific news. Index-level selling, not a story.
AMZN	260.11	▼ -2.16%	\$2.81T	Worst of the seven. Fell with Walmart — the consumer read crossed the aisle from bricks to e-commerce.
META	545.83	▼ -0.04%	\$1.39T	Effectively flat — -0.04% — but with a 10.7-point intraday range. The tape moved it and put it back.
TSLA	345.13	▼ -1.71%	\$1.36T	Low 338.96, closing 6.17 above it. High-beta consumer discretionary on a day XLY fell 1.61%.

Aggregate Mag7 capitalisation \$23.07tn; cap-weighted day change -1.10%, against the S&P's -0.87%. Mega-cap tech underperformed the index it dominates — the breadth was slightly better than the headline, not worse. Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic at capture and will differ marginally from float-adjusted index weights.

6 Positioning & options

- **A forced-deleveraging signature, not a directional view.** Hedgeye's Macro Show described the most-shortened names surging while crowded momentum longs were sold, and attributed it to hedge-fund risk budgets breaking: losses force short covering while profitable longs are sold to rebalance. Wednesday's Most Consensus Short Healthcare basket ramped **+6.4%**; the High Beta Momentum basket fell **7.3%**. Thursday partly reversed it, with XLV the worst sector at -1.87%.
- **Month-end is the stated endpoint.** Hedgeye expects the liquidation dynamics to run into month-end and no further, which places the resolution inside the same week as Nvidia and Jackson Hole. Between now and then, moves in short baskets, financials and aerospace may reflect portfolio mechanics rather than information.
- **Volume confirms participation.** ES traded **1.40m** against a 1.12m ten-day average (+25%); RTY **154k** against 124k (+24%); NQ **550k** against 475k (+16%). The Russell saw the heaviest relative volume and the worst performance — that is where the unwind is concentrated.
- **Volatility rose without breaking out.** VIX +7.66% to **16.02**, closing at 90% of its daily range and 92% of the Hedgeye band, but 16 handles remain far below the 35.30 twelve-month high. Bond volatility told the same story: MOVE 73.18, up 2.69%, still under 75.
- **The after-hours tape was inert.** Every S&P sector SPDR finished the post-close session within 0.31% of its 16:00 mark; SPY +0.08%, QQQ +0.03%, IWM +0.03%. Nothing that settled at 16:00 was repriced by 18:00 ET. Whatever is driving this is not headline-driven overnight.
- **What this section cannot see.** No put/call ratio, gamma-exposure estimate, CFTC positioning or dealer-flow data was available to this account at capture. The positioning read above is inferred from price, volume and Hedgeye's own commentary, and is weaker for it.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

ETF	SECTOR	DAY	CLOSE	NOTE
XLE	Energy	▲ +0.27%	63.75	Crude +2.89% and Hedgeye flipping bullish Energy this week. The only sector with a fundamental reason to be up.
XLRE	Real Estate	▲ +0.20%	45.08	Up on a day the 10-year rose 6.7 bp — counter-intuitive, and the one sector move with no clean explanation.

ETF	SECTOR	DAY	CLOSE	NOTE
XLB	Materials	▼ -0.19%	52.42	Cushioned by precious metals; copper's 0.42% fall capped it.
XLK	Technology	▼ -0.29%	183.10	Beat the index despite the Nasdaq lagging — memory semis inside XLK did the work.
XLU	Utilities	▼ -0.57%	43.77	A bond proxy on a rising-yield day. Hedgeye covered part of its short here on the rates move.
XLC	Comm Services	▼ -0.57%	110.68	Meta flat, Alphabet -1.17%. Split down the middle.
XLF	Financials	▼ -0.92%	56.95	A steepening curve should help banks; it did not, which points at the deleveraging rather than the fundamentals.
XLI	Industrials	▼ -1.20%	179.77	Boeing -3.16% inside the Dow. Aerospace named by Hedgeye as a crowded-position casualty.
XLP	Staples	▼ -1.41%	85.32	Walmart is not in XLP, but the consumer read is. Defensives offered no defence.
XLY	Cons Discretionary	▼ -1.61%	116.68	Amazon -2.16%, Home Depot -2.72%, Tesla -1.71%. The Walmart print landed here hardest.
XLV	Health Care	▼ -1.87%	172.39	Worst sector. Gave back half of Wednesday's +3.5% squeeze as Moderna fell ~20% after its record one-day rally.

- **Leaders:** Energy +0.27% and Real Estate +0.20% were the only sectors to finish green — and only two of eleven. On a day the S&P fell 0.87%, nine sectors fell.
- **Laggards:** Health Care -1.87%, Consumer Discretionary -1.61%, Staples -1.41%. Both ends of the consumer — the trade-up and the trade-down — were sold together, which is the Walmart read propagating.
- **The rotation is not defensive.** A genuine risk-off day sends Staples and Utilities up and Discretionary down. Thursday sent Staples down 1.41% and Utilities down 0.57% while Energy rose. That is a rates-and-commodities day wearing a risk-off costume, and it explains why credit did not move.
- **Health Care's round trip is the week's cleanest lesson in positioning.** The Merck–Moderna melanoma readout on Wednesday triggered a violent short-cover; Thursday, Moderna fell roughly 20% as the trade unwound and XLV led the market lower. Hedgeye sold some XLV into Wednesday's strength and kept the position — the trim, not the thesis, was the call.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The Globex session reopened at 18:00 ET, seven minutes before capture, so the futures rows in section 1 are effectively Thursday's settles with the first prints of the new session layered on a ten-minute-delayed feed. ES settled **7,662.50** against a 7,657.75–7,746.50 range — it never traded below the cash low, and it closed the Globex session in the bottom 5% of that range. The premium of ES over cash SPX is 21.3 points, which is ordinary carry, not a signal. There is no overnight gap to trade yet: the meaningful information between now and the Tokyo open will come from Japan's July CPI at 07:30 GMT+8 and from whatever the Iran headlines do to crude while Asia is awake.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Fri 21 Aug	Japan July CPI 07:30. Asia opens into a 0.87% S&P decline and a 6.7 bp back-up in the US 10-year. US calendar effectively empty — flash PMIs are the only candidate and were not confirmed on the exchange calendar at capture. The tape is left to the oil headlines.
Mon 24 Aug	No tier-one US release scheduled. First full session of the month-end window Hedgeye identifies as the endpoint of the hedge-fund deleveraging.
Tue 25 Aug	Conference Board Consumer Confidence (Aug) 22:00; S&P CoreLogic Case-Shiller (Jun) 21:00; Richmond Fed manufacturing (Aug) 22:00. The confidence print is the first read on whether Walmart's comp miss is a company problem or a consumer one.
Wed 26 Aug	Personal income & spending with PCE (Jul) 20:30; durable goods (Jul, preliminary) 20:30; Q2 GDP second estimate 20:30. Then NVIDIA Q2 results after the US close — roughly 04:20 GMT+8 Thursday. The single largest scheduled risk event of the week.
Thu 27 Aug	Jackson Hole symposium opens (27–29 August), theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy". Wholesale inventories (Jul, preliminary) 20:30. Asia trades the Nvidia print during its own session.
Fri 28 Aug	Fed Chair Kevin Warsh delivers his first Jackson Hole keynote , ~22:00 GMT+8. Chicago PMI (Aug) 21:45; University of Michigan sentiment (Aug, final) 22:00. Warsh has said he wants the speech to "frame the big questions" rather than debate quarter-point moves.
Ahead	FOMC 15–16 September. August CPI on 11 September — the print Hedgeye's nowcast puts at +3.48% y/y, a 12 bp sequential acceleration.

US release times converted from ET at +12h (US daylight time). Calendar entries for 25–28 August are drawn from secondary economic calendars and are marked *unconfirmed* against the releasing agencies; the Nvidia date and the Jackson Hole dates are confirmed. Times for individual releases may shift by 15–30 minutes.

9 Corporate news

- **Walmart –9.0%.** Q2 EPS **\$0.81** against \$0.74 consensus and revenue **\$187.9bn** against \$186.75bn — a beat on both lines. US comparable sales **+2.6%** against a **+3.8%** consensus, the slowest since 2020, with average ticket **+1.1%** against **+3.1%** a year ago. Q3 adjusted EPS guided to **\$0.62–0.64** against \$0.68 consensus. Full-year guidance was **raised** — net sales growth to 4.0–5.0% from 3.5–4.5%. Management said it is cutting prices to defend share and is directing tariff refunds into those cuts; adjusted operating income carried a 750 bp benefit from tariff refunds. Declining drug prices, partly from Medicare prescription rules, weighed on US sales.
- **Moderna fell roughly 20%,** giving back a large part of the biggest one-day rally in the company's history. Wednesday's move followed the Merck–Moderna Phase 3 *INTerpath-001* readout, in which intismeran autogene plus Keytruda met its primary endpoint of recurrence-free survival and a key secondary endpoint of distant metastasis-free survival in resected stage IIB–IV **melanoma** — described by the companies as the first positive Phase 3 for an individualised neoantigen therapy. Merck rose 7% on Wednesday to \$144.60.
- **Memory led the semis.** Micron **+3.97%** to \$974.33, SanDisk **+2.02%**, Western Digital **+1.51%**, AMD **+0.65%**, Broadcom **+0.43%** — against Nvidia **–0.33%** and Intel **–0.72%**. DRAM, NAND and HBM pricing has risen sharply through 2026 and HBM capacity is reported sold out; this is a shortage trade, and it is now diverging from the accelerator trade inside the same index.
- **Crypto equities followed Bitcoin up.** Coinbase **+6.1%** amid a White House crypto summit featuring its chief executive; Strategy (MSTR) **+4.6%**. Hedgeye removed its MSTY short the same morning.
- **Two profit warnings the index ignored.** Advance Auto Parts fell about **25%** on weak revenue and guidance; Coty fell **18%** after missing Q4 and declining to guide FY27; Wolfspeed fell **11.1%** on a wider loss. Three separate consumer- and industrial-facing companies withdrawing or missing on the same day is a pattern worth more attention than it received.
- **Dow-level damage was concentrated.** Walmart **–9.04%**, Boeing **–3.16%**, Home Depot **–2.72%**; Coca-Cola **+1.16%** was the best component. Boeing and Home Depot are both names Hedgeye flags as crowded institutional positions caught in the deleveraging.

10 Macro data

- **Initial jobless claims 206,000,** against a **210,000** consensus and 209,000 prior. A beat, and the streak of low readings since July's near-60-year low of 189,000 remains intact. **Continuing claims rose 18,000 to 1,799,000** — the divergence matters: people are not being fired, and those who lose jobs are taking longer to find new ones.
- **Philadelphia Fed manufacturing:** consensus **24.1** against a prior of **41.4**. A consensus that expects a 17-point sequential collapse in a regional survey is itself the story; the actual print was not independently confirmed by this account before capture and is recorded as a gap in section 18.
- **Fed minutes read more hawkish than expected.** Released Wednesday, they were cited by market strategists on Thursday as the second leg of the rates move — policymakers concerned about inflation at exactly the moment the Treasury is trying to suppress long-end borrowing costs. The tension between those two facts is what the bond market repriced.
- **The inflation forecast is accelerating, not decelerating.** Hedgeye's nowcast puts August headline CPI at **+3.48% y/y** — a 12 bp sequential acceleration against the slowing the government reported for July — with 3Q26 at 3.43% and 4Q26 at 3.61%. This is a house estimate, not an official one, and it is the number their curve and commodity positioning is built on.
- **Nothing on the calendar contradicted the labour market.** Claims at 206k with a 2.6% Walmart comp is the stagflationary shape: employment holding, real spending decelerating, headline inflation forecast to reaccelerate on energy.

11 Geopolitics

- ▲ **Trump threatened a "crushing economic operation" against Iran,** posting on social media that it would be the "MOST CRUSHING ECONOMIC OPERATION EVER TAKEN AGAINST ANY COUNTRY". Tehran dismissed the threat as a "diversion" and said it "will only bring further defeat". Crude rose 2.89% on the exchange; both characterisations are the parties' own.
- ▲ **The Strait of Hormuz remains the central commodity risk.** Traffic has been severely disrupted for most of the past five months by Iranian attacks on shipping and retaliatory US strikes, and Brent spot reached as high as \$105 in late July. Iran has set conditions for reopening — lifting the naval blockade and sanctions, US withdrawal from the region, war reparations and release of frozen assets — which are Tehran's stated demands, not an agreed framework.

- ◆ **The UAE has been drawn in directly.** Abu Dhabi National Oil Company said one of its vessels was targeted by a missile in the Strait; the UAE has suspended financial and economic transactions with Iran after accusing Tehran of launching ballistic missiles at its territory. A Gulf state moving from bystander to participant changes the escalation arithmetic.
- ◆ **The market is pricing risk, not war.** Brent at \$93.78 is well below the \$105 July spike and roughly a month high. The Brent–WTI spread of \$6.95 is where the seaborne risk premium actually sits, and it is the number to watch rather than the flat price.
- ▼ **Away from the Gulf, the space race narrowed.** Chinese startup LandSpace landed the first stage of its Zhuque-3 rocket on a pad in northwest China — the first land recovery of an orbital-class booster by a Chinese company. SpaceX fell 1.61% ahead of a second post-IPO unlock of up to 319 million shares.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE 06:07	CHANGE	VOLUME	NOTE
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,662.50	▼ -0.86%	1.40m	25% above the 10-day average. Settled in the bottom 5% of the Globex range.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,300.50	▼ -0.72%	550k	16% above average. Held up better than ES on the memory bid.
E-mini Dow (YM)	52,849	▼ -1.27%	69k	31% above average — the Walmart print concentrated here.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,999.2	▼ -1.34%	154k	24% above average, and the worst performer. This is where the unwind is.
USD/JPY	159.023	◆	—	Yen is a Hedgeye long and flagged overbought. Nikkei closed +1.36% at 66,216.57 on Thursday.
USD/KRW	1,394.05	◆	—	Won softer despite the KOSPI's +5.89%. The equity inflow is not being currency-hedged.
USD/TWD	31.8188	◆	—	The cleanest proxy for foreign appetite for the Taiwan chip complex. Watch it against the SOX's +0.53%.
USD/CNH	6.7235	◆	—	Offshore yuan barely moved. Beijing is not letting the dollar story reach the renminbi.
EUR/USD	1.1682	◆	—	Euro is a Hedgeye long, described as overbought around 1.171 on Thursday's Macro Show. Sits at 1.1682.
Gold (spot)	4,520.35	▲ +0.57%	—	\$4,520.35, at 88% of a band whose ceiling was lifted 104 points overnight.
Silver (spot)	68.156	▲ +3.46%	—	\$68.156, upgraded to bullish TREND. Futures rose 3.46% on the day against gold futures' 0.57%.
Copper (spot)	6.4407	▼ -0.42%	—	\$6.4407, at 25% of band — the industrial metal is not confirming the monetary metals.
WTI (CL1!)	86.83	▲ +2.89%	—	\$86.83, month high, 76% of band. The instrument most likely to move Asia.
Brent (BZ1!)	93.78	▲ +2.36%	—	\$93.78. Spread to WTI \$6.95 — the Hormuz premium in one number.
Bitcoin	72,570	▲ +4.74%	—	\$72,570. Range 68,866–72,950. Genuinely live and genuinely the day's biggest mover.
Ether	2,315.77	▲ +2.87%	—	\$2,315.77. Lagged Bitcoin by 187 bp — this is a Bitcoin story, not a crypto-beta story.

All rows live at the 06:07 GMT+8 capture. FX change cells are marked flat because those series rolled session at 17:00–18:00 ET, minutes before capture; the levels are current, the percentages are not Thursday's move. Metals change is measured on the COMEX contract. Asian index levels quoted in the bullets below are *previous closes* from Thursday's Asian session.

- **The US tape hands Asia a rates problem, not a tech problem.** The SOX rose 0.53% and Technology was the fourth-best sector. What fell was the consumer, healthcare and small caps. Asia has no direct exposure to a Walmart comp miss, so the mechanical read-across is weaker than the headline –0.87% suggests.
- **Korea is the one that has to reprice.** KOSPI closed Thursday at **6,852.59, up 5.89%** — its own violent reversal of Wednesday's –5.8%, on Samsung **+9.49%** (a reported shareholder-return programme above KRW 100tn) and SK hynix **+12.80%** (a record KRW 40tn buyback and cancellation). Those are company-specific catalysts, so they should survive a soft US handover, but a 5.89% day that triggered a sidecar halt is not a level anyone defends easily. Hedgeye flagged the KOSPI TRADE momentum signal at 6,798 on Wednesday; the index closed 54 points above it.

- **Japan opens long the wrong currency.** Nikkei closed **66,216.57, +1.36%** Thursday after falling 3.2% on Wednesday when it broke Hedgeye's TRADE signal on the yen plans. July CPI at 07:30 GMT+8 lands before the cash open, and USD/JPY at 159.02 leaves no room for a hawkish surprise to be ignored.
- **China and Hong Kong have the least to react to.** Shanghai Composite closed **3,903.72, +0.24%** and the Hang Seng **25,698.50, +0.86%**. USD/CNH barely moved. The dollar story that is repricing gold, bitcoin and the euro is not being transmitted through the renminbi.
- **The single instrument most likely to move is crude.** WTI at \$86.83 is at 76% of its risk range with an open-ended political headline attached to it and a US administration promising escalation. Every Asian index is a net oil importer; a \$90 WTI print during the Asian session does more damage to Tokyo, Seoul and Mumbai than anything that happened in New York on Thursday.

13 AI watch

- **The trade has split in two, and Thursday made it visible.** Memory rose — Micron +3.97%, SanDisk +2.02%, Western Digital +1.51% — while the accelerator complex did not: Nvidia -0.33%, Broadcom +0.43%. Hedgeye's framing on Thursday was that strong Nvidia quarters have repeatedly been followed by Nvidia weakness as money rotated into downstream beneficiaries, and that those beneficiaries have now been heavily liquidated — creating a materially different setup into Wednesday's print.
- **Memory scarcity is now a price phenomenon, not a forecast.** DRAM, NAND and HBM pricing rose 80–90% from Q4 2025 to Q1 2026; HBM capacity is reported sold out through 2026 and Samsung and SK hynix raised HBM3E supply pricing by close to 20%. Enterprise 64GB DDR5 RDIMM pricing is projected to move from roughly \$873 in Q1 to about \$1,586 by Q4. That is an input-cost problem arriving on the income statements of everyone building AI infrastructure.
- **Capital commitments keep escalating.** Nvidia is reported to be preparing to back roughly \$100bn of OpenAI financing; Anthropic has committed \$50bn to US computing infrastructure with sites coming online through 2026; Meta has committed to roughly \$600bn of data centres over three years, and the Stargate partnership to \$500bn. These are announced intentions of varying firmness, not contracted spend, and should be read as such.
- **The physical constraint is becoming a legal one.** Pennsylvania's governor signed an executive order on 18 August making the state's GRID standards binding on data-centre developers, requiring consent orders committing them to local approval and full funding of new electricity infrastructure. Power, not silicon, is where the next bottleneck gets adjudicated.
- **The SOX has not participated.** It closed **19.5%** below its 52-week high on a day it outperformed every other index. Whatever the AI capital cycle is doing, the semiconductor index has spent a year not making new highs while the S&P sat 2.25% from its own.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Continuing claims are the number nobody led with.** Initial claims beat at 206,000 and made the headlines; continuing claims rose 18,000 to **1,799,000**. Firms are not firing, but the people who do lose jobs are staying unemployed longer. That is how labour markets soften — from the exit rate, not the entry rate — and it is invisible in the print everyone quotes.
- **Walmart's operating income carried a 750 basis point benefit from tariff refunds.** The company is recycling those refunds into price cuts to defend share. Strip the refund and the margin story is materially different; the policy is subsidising the price war, and when the refunds stop, the prices do not automatically go back up.
- **Real estate rose on a day the 10-year rose 6.7 basis points.** XLRE +0.20% is the sector move with no clean explanation, and the honest answer is that it is probably positioning rather than fundamentals. Hedgeye's housing work this week made the opposite point — mortgage rates stuck in a 6–7% band since mid-2022, purchase lock volume down 31% versus 2019, existing home sales down about 18%, and June home price appreciation of +1.6% nominal but roughly -2.5% real, with 42 of the 54 largest metros negative in real terms.
- **The gold–silver ratio did more work than either metal.** Silver futures +3.46% against gold futures +0.57% on the same dollar move. When silver outruns gold by three points in a session, the marginal buyer is not hedging inflation — it is a leveraged bet on the same trade, which historically arrives late rather than early.
- **Jeff Bezos took his first sports-ownership position,** investing in Liverpool Football Club through an investor consortium. Not a market event; a reasonable leading indicator of where late-cycle capital goes looking for scarce assets.

15 Appendix — stock cards

NVDA NVIDIA

216.85 ▼ **-0.33%**

Cap \$5.25T · Not in the published risk-range set · Next: Q2 results Wed 26 Aug, after the US close

Held up better than the index on a day the SOX rose and the Nasdaq fell. Hedgeye expects a beat and better guidance to be broadly consensus; the variables that matter are the magnitude of the guide and order growth. The novel factor this quarter is that the downstream AI beneficiaries that usually absorb the post-print rotation have already been liquidated.

WMT WALMART

— **see read**

Not held in the capture set · Next: Q3 results late November

Beat EPS and revenue, raised the year, and fell 9% on a 2.6% US comp against 3.8% expected — the slowest since 2020. Average ticket +1.1% against +3.1%. Q3 guide of \$0.62–0.64 missed \$0.68. A 750 bp tariff-refund benefit is funding the price cuts.

MU MICRON

974.33 ▲ **+3.97%**

Cap \$1.10T · Not in the published risk-range set · Next: Fiscal Q4 results late September

Best large-cap semi on the day. Traded 929.07–977.28 on 25.0m shares and closed near the high. The memory shortage is now visible in realised pricing rather than in forecasts — DRAM, NAND and HBM up 80–90% since Q4 2025, HBM sold out through 2026.

XLV HEALTH CARE SPDR

172.39 ▼ **-1.87%**

Cap — · 167–177, bullish TREND, 53.9% of band · Next: Rebalance and month-end, late August

Worst sector at –1.87%, giving back half of Wednesday's +3.5%. Hedgeye's core long, **trimmed into strength, not exited**; the band ceiling was raised 5 points overnight to absorb the squeeze. Mid-band is a comfortable place for a position with this much short interest behind it.

AMZN AMAZON

260.11 ▼ **-2.16%**

Cap \$2.81T · Not in the published risk-range set · Next: Q3 results late October

Worst of the Mag7. Fell with Walmart, which is the more interesting fact than the size of the move: the consumer read crossed from bricks to e-commerce on the same day, so the market treated it as a demand signal rather than a share-shift signal.

LLY ELI LILLY

1,244.40 ▼ **-2.81%**

Cap \$1.17T · Not in the published risk-range set · Next: Q3 results late October

Fell 2.81% to \$1,244.40 — the largest single-name drag inside a healthcare sector that led the market lower. Traded 1,243.23–1,280.28 and closed within a dollar of the low. Recovered 0.29% after hours.

COIN COINBASE

— **see read**

Not held in the capture set · Next: Q3 results early November

Rose 6.1% on the Bitcoin breakout and a White House crypto summit featuring its chief executive. The cleanest listed expression of the one intervention that worked, and therefore the cleanest thing to lose if the Treasury bid proves to be a single day.

BA BOEING

— **see read**

Removed from Signal Strength Stocks, 20 Aug · Next: Q3 results late October

Fell 3.16%, the second-largest Dow drag after Walmart, and was removed from Hedgeye's Signal Strength list the same afternoon. Aerospace is named explicitly as a crowded institutional position caught in the deleveraging rather than a fundamental repricing.

Walmart, Coinbase and Boeing were not in this morning's capture set; their moves are taken from named session reports and are secondary marks, flagged again in section 18. All other prices are the 20 August settled close.

16 About this edition

- **COVERS** — Thursday 20 August's US cash session as settled at 16:00 ET, the after-hours tape to 18:00 ET, the Globex session to the capture, and the full Hedgeye evening publication set. Asian cash markets have not opened: Tokyo and Seoul 08:00–08:30 GMT+8, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15.
- **CAPTURED** — a single window, **06:07:20–06:07:23 GMT+8**, 2.3 seconds wide, via the standard concurrent capture. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments in 0.7 seconds. Yahoo, the intended cross-check, was blocked by rate limiting and returned nothing; this edition is **TradingView-single-sourced**. Divergences and the reconciliation that was possible are set out in section 18.
- **SETTLED VS LIVE** — US cash indices and sector ETFs are settled closes. Futures, Treasury yields, spot metals, FX, VIX and crypto are live levels at 06:07 GMT+8; the futures feed carries a ten-minute delay and Globex had reopened only seven minutes before capture, so futures rows are effectively Thursday's settles. Asian and European index levels are previous closes.
- **HEDGEYE EDITION** — **Full, logged-in**. The live risk-range set is *Double MAX Macro!*, the Early Look of 20 August 2026 by **Keith McCullough**, published 20:22 GMT+8. Tonight's Early Look supersedes it at roughly 19:30–20:30 GMT+8. Also read: The Macro Show summary (22:12 GMT+8), the ETF Pro Plus update (21:50), Signal Strength Stocks (03:44 GMT+8 today), KM's Top 3 Things (19 Aug), and the 19 August Early Look by Matthew Cooper for the day-over-day band comparison.

- **QUAD PATH — 3 → 1 → 2, unchanged.** Monthly Quad 3 now, with the model forecasting Quad 1 next month. One signal did change overnight: silver moved from **neutral to bullish TREND**.
- **NOT AVAILABLE** — the Yahoo cross-check; the actual Philadelphia Fed print; options positioning of any kind; the Chart of the Day, MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant, which did not appear in the feed window read this morning.

17 Sources

PRICES. TradingView bulk scanner, single query at 06:07:20–06:07:21 GMT+8, 96 instruments including the US 2-year cash yield and the ICE BofA MOVE index. Yahoo Finance was queried concurrently at 06:07:20–06:07:23 and returned zero of 62 requests under HTTP 429 rate limiting.

HEDGEYE. app.hedgeye.com, logged in, read 06:10–06:20 GMT+8: the Early Look category feed and the full research feed, plus the individual items named in section 16.

MACRO. Consensus and actual figures for initial jobless claims and the Philadelphia Fed index via Investing.com and Trading Economics; Federal Reserve minutes as reported by named market strategists. Hedgeye's CPI nowcast is a house estimate from the Early Look.

SESSION NARRATIVE AND SINGLE STOCKS. TheStreet's 20 August live blog (Rob Lenihan and Noah Weidner), CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Reuters via TheStreet, and the Merck corporate release for the INTERpath-001 readout. Korean single-stock moves via Korea JoongAng Daily and KED Global; Applied Materials' quarter was reported 13 August and is not part of this session.

COMMODITIES, GEOPOLITICS AND AI. CNBC and Fortune for crude; CNN, CNBC and Congressional Research Service material for the Strait of Hormuz; Forbes, CoinDesk and crypto.news for the Treasury buyback and Bitcoin; Anthropic, TechCrunch, Tech Startups and CNBC for AI infrastructure and memory pricing. Contested political claims are attributed to the party that made them.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash index arithmetic is self-consistent to three decimal places on all six indices.** S&P: prior 7,707.98 – 66.82 = 7,641.16, implied –0.867% against –0.867% reported. Nasdaq Composite: 26,331.09 – 263.92 = 26,067.17, –1.002% / –1.002%. Dow: 53,463.05 – 703.84 = 52,759.21, –1.316% / –1.316%. Russell: 3,032.94 – 40.51 = 2,992.43, –1.336% / –1.336%. SOX: 11,738.23 + 61.78 = 11,800.01, +0.526% / +0.526%. VIX: 14.88 + 1.14 = 16.02, +7.661% / +7.661%.
- **Every futures row reconciles to its prior settle.** ES 7,729.00 – 66.50 = 7,662.50; NQ 29,512.75 – 212.25 = 29,300.50; YM 53,530 – 681 = 52,849; RTY 3,039.90 – 40.70 = 2,999.20. Each basis to cash is a normal positive carry — ES +21.34 over SPX, YM +89.79 over the Dow, RTY +6.77 over the Russell — with no row implying a dislocation.
- **Three independent instruments confirm the semiconductor divergence.** SOX +0.53%, SOXX +0.52%, SMH +0.31%, against S&P –0.87%. The single most counter-intuitive fact in the brief is corroborated by two ETFs and an index computed by different providers, so it is not a bad tick.
- **Breadth arithmetic ties.** The cap-weighted Mag7 fell 1.10% against the S&P's 0.87%, and RSP (equal weight) fell 0.81% against SPY's 0.84%. Equal weight beat cap weight by 3 bp, which is exactly what mega-cap underperformance should produce. SPY vs SPX differs by 3 bp, inside dividend and NAV noise.
- **The curve reconciles against Hedgeye's own quote.** Wednesday's close implies 10s–2s of 47.9 bp; Keith McCullough wrote “+50bps this morning” at 08:22 ET Thursday; our 18:07 ET capture gives **51.8 bp**. A 3.9 bp steepening across the session with the quoted figure sitting between the two endpoints.
- **Commodity ETFs corroborate the futures moves.** GLD +0.34% against gold futures +0.57%; SLV +2.75% against silver futures +3.46%; USO +2.77% against WTI +2.89%. All three directionally identical with gaps inside normal NAV and roll effects.
- **Reconciliation counts, as printed by the capture: 0 matched within 5 bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** No pair could be cross-checked because the second source returned nothing. That is the honest headline number for this edition and it is worse than any run in which divergences are found and resolved.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **The entire edition is single-sourced.** Yahoo was queried concurrently and returned 0 of 62 requests, aborting on the five-consecutive-429 circuit breaker after 2.3 seconds. Every price in this brief rests on one provider. The last time this brief ran single-sourced, the subsequent reconciliation found six defects that were invisible from inside one source. Treat all levels as provisional to roughly one provider's worth of confidence.
- **FX and spot-metal percentage changes were suppressed, not reported.** Those series roll their trading session at 17:00–18:00 ET, seven minutes before capture, so the changes the feed returns — DXY +0.07%, EUR/USD +0.03%, USD/JPY –0.02%, gold spot +0.03%, silver spot +0.14%, copper spot –0.01% — measure minutes, not Thursday. Publishing them as day changes would have been wrong by the full size of the session move, which for silver was over three percentage points. Levels are correct; for the metals the change column uses the COMEX contract instead, and for the three FX rows no comparable day change was available.
- **Hedgeye's own Macro Show summary misidentifies the healthcare catalyst.** It attributes Wednesday's squeeze to a “Moderna/Merck Phase III multiple-myeloma study”. Merck's corporate release and the trade press describe INTERpath-001 as a trial in completely resected stage IIB–IV melanoma. This brief follows the company release. Hedgeye's summary carries its own notice that it is AI-enhanced and may contain errors.

- **Hedgeye publishes two different 10-year bands in the same note.** The prose states “Risk Range™ Signal = 4.63-4.74%”; the OUR LEVELS table states 4.61–4.74. This brief uses the levels table, which puts the 10-year at **75.4%** of band. On the prose band the same print sits at **60.0%** — a 15-point difference in the headline statistic, so the choice is material and is disclosed rather than buried.
- **The 19 August Early Look prints the Russell band as “7992-3083”,** an evident typo for 2992. The day-over-day floor comparison for the Russell is therefore omitted from the risk-range table; the ceiling comparison of +2 points is retained because it is unaffected.
- **Several single-stock marks are secondary and timestamped elsewhere.** Walmart, Coinbase and Boeing were not in the capture set; their moves come from session reporting, where Walmart's fall is variously given as 8.91%, 9.0%, 9.04% and 9.3% depending on the timestamp. Wednesday's Bitcoin move is reported as +8.2% by one outlet and +11.5% intraday by another; this brief quotes its own captured Thursday figure of **+4.74%** and attributes the Wednesday numbers to the sources that published them. Oil marks also drift: TheStreet had WTI \$86.78 and Brent \$93.98 at 07:11 ET against our \$86.83 and \$93.78 at 18:07 ET — a 20-cent, 21 bp gap on Brent, resolved in favour of our own capture.
- **Market capitalisations are approximate.** They are TradingView's *market_cap_basic* at capture, not float-adjusted index weights, so the \$23.07tn Mag7 aggregate and the −1.10% cap-weighted change carry perhaps a percentage point of construction uncertainty. The comparison to the S&P is directionally safe; the absolute figure is not a precision number.

KNOWN GAPS

- **The Yahoo cross-check is missing entirely,** and with it the multi-day daily bars that normally provide week-on-week context. No week-over-week comparisons are made anywhere in this brief for that reason.
- **The actual Philadelphia Fed manufacturing print was not confirmed.** The consensus of 24.1 against a 41.4 prior is reported; the outcome is not. Section 10 states this rather than inferring a number.
- **No options or positioning data of any kind was available** — no put/call ratio, no gamma exposure, no dealer positioning, no CFTC commitments. Section 6 is inferred from price, volume and Hedgeye commentary, and is the weakest section in the brief.
- **Several Hedgeye publications did not appear in the window read.** Chart of the Day, MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, Real-Time Alerts and Capital Allocation Pro were not retrieved. Separately, the full research feed rendered only its top item to the text extractor, so items beneath it were enumerated from the site's recommended-research rail rather than from a complete feed listing, and publications may have been missed. **The absence of a Hedgeye position change in this brief is not evidence that no position change occurred** — it is evidence that this account did not see one.
- **The week-ahead calendar for 25–28 August comes from secondary economic calendars** and is marked unconfirmed against the releasing agencies. The Nvidia reporting date and the Jackson Hole dates are confirmed; individual release times may move by 15–30 minutes.
- **Asian cash markets were shut at capture,** so every Asian index level in section 12 is Thursday's close and is labelled as such. The Nasdaq-100 was not captured, so the QQQ comparison against the Composite is indirect.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **The capture window was 06:07:20–06:07:23 GMT+8 — 2.3 seconds.** No row in this brief was topped up later or taken from a different window. That part of the standard was met comfortably.
- **The futures rows have the least genuine information in them.** Globex reopened at 18:00 ET, seven minutes before capture, on a ten-minute-delayed feed — so those levels are Thursday's settles rather than overnight price discovery. Anything that has happened in the Globex session since 06:00 GMT+8 is not in this document.
- **Bitcoin and Ether are the only continuously-traded rows** and both are moving fast: Bitcoin's range over the captured period was 68,866–72,950, a span of 4,084 points, or 5.9% of the level. That row will be stale soonest.
- **Every risk range in section 4 will be superseded tonight.** The Friday Early Look publishes at roughly 19:30–20:30 GMT+8 and will reset all sixteen bands, the TREND signals and the Quad commentary. The bands printed here were computed off Wednesday's close and describe Thursday, which has now settled.
- **The inflation figure is a forecast, not a release.** Hedgeye's +3.48% August headline CPI is a house nowcast for a print due 11 September. The 3Q26 and 4Q26 figures, and the 2Q27 disinflation call, are model output and nothing more.
- **Everything in section 8 beyond today is scheduled, not realised,** and the two events that matter most — Nvidia on Wednesday and the Warsh keynote on Friday 28 August — are both a week away and both capable of invalidating the framing in section 2.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Asia opens between 90 minutes and six hours after this capture, crude carries an open political headline, and the levels here are a photograph of 06:07 GMT+8.